

GitHub Copilot 101

A brief introduction to Copilot for *all* Hubbers

(Presented by @francisfuzz, courtesy of the #nux team)

I'm @francisfuzz!

- Pronouns: he/him
- Husband and Father  
- Pilipino descent, based in Southern California 
- Senior Software Engineer, New User Experience team 

Thanks for having me! I'm here to help you make the most of GitHub Copilot as a Hubber.



Icebreaker

- Go to <https://github.com/copilot>
- Tell Copilot about 1 thing you did this week and have it write a song in the style of your favorite artist

Where we're going:

Topic (est. time in minutes)

- What is GitHub Copilot? (4)
- Copilot's Suite of Features (4)
- Live Demos, Access, Installation (10)
- Resources (5)
- Questions & Pointers (35)

What is GitHub Copilot? (1/3)

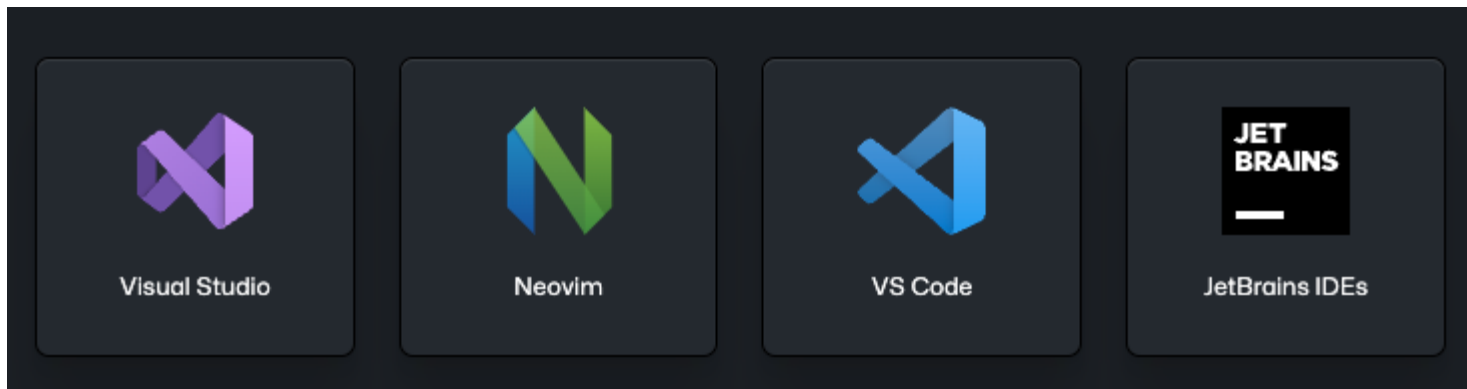
GitHub Copilot is an AI pair programmer that helps you write code faster.

- Allows you to focus more energy on problem solving and collaboration
- Proven to increase developer productivity and accelerate the pace of software development

What is GitHub Copilot? (2/3)

You can use GitHub Copilot in your IDE.

It is available in VSCode, Neovim, JetBrains IDE and Visual Studio.



What is GitHub Copilot? (3/3)

You can use GitHub Copilot on GitHub dotcom.

Talk to your repos, create docs, draft PRs, inquire about issues and more.

Copilot's Suite of Features

- Get code suggestions as you type in your IDE
- Chat with Copilot to ask for help with your code
- Ask Copilot for help using the command line
- Generate a description of the changes in a pull request (Copilot Enterprise only)
- Create and manage collections of documentation, called knowledge bases, to use as a context for chatting with Copilot (Copilot Enterprise only)

Keep up with the latest: <https://github.blog/ai-and-ml/github-copilot/>

Time for demos

- "Dev" Demo
 - 🍔 Exploring a codebase
 - 🍟 Writing a `Food` class
- "For Everyone" Demo: generating great questions

What is GitHub Copilot good for? (1/2)

For developers:

-  Boilerplate code and frameworks
-  Uncommon or confusing syntax
-  Pattern matching
-  Translate Code
-  Cron jobs and regex
-  Helping you remember things you forgot
-  Extending and refactoring existing code
-  Explaining unfamiliar code
-  Documentation (which we all love to write!)
-  Understanding error messages (and fixing it!)
-  Writing unit tests

...and much more! 

What is GitHub Copilot good for? (2/2)

Even if you're not a developer...

For product managers:

-  Analyzing data and generating reports
-  Drafting product specifications and documentation

For designers:

-  Generating code snippets for design prototypes
-  Generating CSS styles to match a particular design system

For any writing-related task (every Hubber):

-  Drafting personalized communications for your audience
-  Proofreading and generating alternative phrasing
-  Translating technical jargon into accessible language

Some Limitations of GitHub Copilot

- GitHub Copilot != Compiler
- The AI cannot read your mind (here's where Francis tells a story)
- The AI is not a replacement for secure, correct coding practices, as well as your unique expertise and skills

Resources

- GitHub Certifications: GitHub Copilot
- Get Started with GitHub Copilot in VS Code (2025)
- How to use GitHub Copilot: Prompts, tips, and use cases
- Prompting GitHub Copilot Chat to become your personal AI assistant for accessibility
- How to build a GPT-3 App with Nextjs, React, and GitHub Copilot

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💧 ✨ Thank you! ✨ 💧

Questions & Pointers

The floor is yours! 